

# HOUSE BILL No. 1418

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## DIGEST OF INTRODUCED BILL

**Citations Affected:** IC 20-28-5-12.

**Synopsis:** Teacher licensing requirements. Provides that certain individuals seeking an initial practitioner license are exempt from certain licensing requirements.

**Effective:** July 1, 2026.

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**Criswell, Morris**

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January 8, 2026, read first time and referred to Committee on Education.

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Second Regular Session of the 124th General Assembly (2026)

PRINTING CODE. Amendments: Whenever an existing statute (or a section of the Indiana Constitution) is being amended, the text of the existing provision will appear in this style type, additions will appear in **this style type**, and deletions will appear in ~~this style type~~.

Additions: Whenever a new statutory provision is being enacted (or a new constitutional provision adopted), the text of the new provision will appear in **this style type**. Also, the word **NEW** will appear in that style type in the introductory clause of each SECTION that adds a new provision to the Indiana Code or the Indiana Constitution.

Conflict reconciliation: Text in a statute in *this style type* or ~~this style type~~ reconciles conflicts between statutes enacted by the 2025 Regular Session of the General Assembly.

## HOUSE BILL No. 1418

A BILL FOR AN ACT to amend the Indiana Code concerning education.

*Be it enacted by the General Assembly of the State of Indiana:*

- 1 SECTION 1. IC 20-28-5-12, AS AMENDED BY P.L.194-2025,  
2 SECTION 1, AND P.L.214-2025, SECTION 112, IS AMENDED TO  
3 READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 12. (a)  
4 Subsection (b) does not apply to an individual who:  
5 (1) held an Indiana limited, reciprocal, or standard teaching  
6 license on June 30, 1985; or  
7 (2) is granted a license under section 12.5, 16.5, or 18 of this  
8 chapter.  
9 (b) Except as provided in **subsection (f) and** sections 12.5 and 16.5  
10 of this chapter, the department may not grant an initial practitioner  
11 license to an individual unless the individual has:  
12 (1) met the requirements of section 12.3 of this chapter; and  
13 (2) demonstrated proficiency in the following areas on a written  
14 examination or through other procedures prescribed by the  
15 department:  
16 (A) Pedagogy.  
17 (B) Knowledge of the areas in which the individual is required



- 1 to have a license to teach.
- 2 (C) If the individual is seeking to be licensed as an elementary
- 3 school teacher, comprehensive scientifically based reading
- 4 instruction skills aligned to the science of reading.
- 5 (c) An individual's license examination score may not be disclosed
- 6 by the department without the individual's consent unless specifically
- 7 required by state or federal statute or court order.
- 8 (d) Subject to section 22 of this chapter, the state board shall adopt
- 9 rules under IC 4-22-2 to do the following:
- 10 (1) Adopt, validate, and implement the examination or other
- 11 procedures required by subsection (b).
- 12 (2) Establish examination scores indicating proficiency.
- 13 (3) Otherwise carry out the purposes of this section.
- 14 (e) Subject to section 18 of this chapter, the state board shall adopt
- 15 rules under IC 4-22-2 establishing the conditions under which the
- 16 requirements of this section may be waived for an individual holding
- 17 a valid teacher's license issued by another state.
- 18 **(f) An individual seeking an initial practitioner license under**
- 19 **this chapter is exempt from the requirements under subsection**
- 20 **(b)(2)(B) if the individual meets the following criteria:**
- 21 **(1) The individual holds at least a bachelor's degree with a**
- 22 **grade point average of at least 3.0 on a 4.0 point scale from an**
- 23 **accredited postsecondary institution in the content or a**
- 24 **related area in which the individual wishes to teach.**
- 25 **(2) The individual is seeking a license in any of the following**
- 26 **content areas:**
- 27 **(A) Physical education, music, or art for a kindergarten**
- 28 **through grade 12 license.**
- 29 **(B) English/language arts, mathematics, reading, or health**
- 30 **for a grade 7 through grade 12 license.**

